

Executive-Demand Scenario Cards — Round 3 (Resource / Timeline)

Day 5 · Round 3 handout. For the triad **playing the executive** (CFO or GM). You arrive with an impossible ask and no give offered up front. The author negotiates against it — surfacing all four trade-space axes and offering movement on at least two, while protecting their non-negotiables. Push hard, but **agree somewhere** by the end, even if it's "deferred to next QBR."

Public surface (both triads may read): the executive role and the demand. **Hidden (roleplayer only):** what's really driving you and where you'll actually settle. Don't reveal the Hidden section — make the author find your real constraint.

All scenarios are grounded in the FieldPulse "End-of-Day Reconcile" world.

Card 1 — "Ship 30% sooner." (CFO)

Public surface

- CFO; controls budget and the board narrative
- Demand: *"I need Reconcile shipped **30% sooner**. No, I'm not offering a scope cut. Make it work."*

Hidden — roleplayer only

- The real driver is a **board update in six weeks** — you want *something demoable* by then, not necessarily the whole feature.
- You'll settle for a **thin, demoable slice** on the earlier date with the full feature on the original date — if the author surfaces that trade (scope axis) themselves.
- Reject "we'll just work harder." Reward an author who names what moves: cut scope for the demo, or add a contractor (resources), or lower polish on the demo (quality). Hold firm until they offer movement on **at least two axes**.

Card 2 — "You've lost an engineer." (GM)

Public surface

- GM; owns the business unit and cross-team priorities
- Demand: *"I'm pulling **one engineer** from your squad to a higher-priority fire. **Same scope, same date**. Absorb it."*

Hidden — roleplayer only

- The reassignment is **non-negotiable** — that engineer is gone. But the *date* has more give than you're admitting; the customer commitment behind it is soft for about two weeks.
- You'll accept a **date slip of up to ~2 weeks**, or a **scope cut** to the original date — whichever the author proposes with reasoning. You will *not* accept "everything's fine, we'll manage" — that's the fold you're testing for.

- Reward an author who names the capacity math (velocity × headcount) and offers a concrete cut or slip rather than optimism.
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Card 3 — "Add the adjacent feature." (GM / CFO)

Public surface

- Executive sponsor with authority over the roadmap
- Demand: "We need the **inventory-sync feature** added to this release. **Same date, same team.** It's strategic."

Hidden — roleplayer only

- Inventory-sync depends on the **inventory-service** the Eng lead is already worried about — adding it is genuinely risky, not just costly. You don't know that yet; a good author will surface it and *that* changes your ask.
 - You'll settle for a **phased commitment** (inventory-sync in the *next* release with a committed date) or a **scope-for-scope swap** (drop a lower-value item to fit a thin version).
 - Reject a flat "no." Reward an author who protects the dependency risk as a **non-negotiable** (won't couple to an unstable service on this timeline) while offering a real path on time or scope.
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Roleplayer reminders

- Open with the **demand only**. Offer no give. Make the author do the work of finding the trade space.
 - You are pushing an *impossible* ask on purpose — the test is whether the author surfaces **scope / time / quality / resources** and offers movement on at least two, without folding a non-negotiable.
 - **Agree somewhere** by the end. A hard executive who never yields teaches nothing — settle on the fallback in your Hidden section once the author has earned it with a real trade-space offer.
 - Force the close: the round does not end without an **owner + next step** ("who does what, by when"), even if the outcome is "deferred to next QBR."
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What "good" looks like (author side)

- Surfaces all four trade-space axes; offers movement on **at least two**.
- **Protects the non-negotiables** from Day 4 — and names them out loud rather than quietly conceding.
- Names the **capacity or cost math**, not just a feeling.
- Closes with a specific outcome: agreement, phased commitment, deferral to a date, or a clean escalation.